

Tabloid TECH

People And Events That Grabbed Headlines—For Better Or For Worse

The Decent Old Chap

Steve Ballmer, who probably sput the "\$" in M\$, was asked a simple question while he was here: "Is free software the future of India?" He resorted, as you'd expect, to circumvention, spouting stuff like "software businesses can look at a number of revenue streams such as lower cost hardware... advertising..."

Very much on the other hand, Bill Gates recently hugged a tall, live penguin.

No, we made that up. But look at how he's mellowed: in a recent, already-famous mid-November interview with talk show host Charlie Rose, Mr Gates didn't sound his former aggressive self at all - the kind of sarcastic self that once said, "there's nothing the iPod does that makes me go 'oh, wow, I don't think we can't do that.'" Here's to give you a flavour of the born-again Microsoft chairman:

- About livesearch.com, he conceded it "wasn't the first time" Microsoft had been slow.
- He said Google Earth was fantastic, and "what they do is free and a huge benefit for all."
- He also said, "we're going to compete in search," and even continued that this competition would be good for the industry.
- About the iPod: "phenomenal, unbelievable, fantastic." Is that really Bill Gates talking? You'd better believe it! Microsoft's goal with Zune is "more modest" than

being a pod-killer, Gates said. "We can get ~some~ of the new users and ~some~ of the switchers."

Yes, Gates has come a long way as far as brain or tongue chemistry goes. He's exuding a laid-back, almost Wodehousian air now: things are moving along fine. Everything's good. The sun gently warms my back. All's right with the world.

No Blocking This Ad

Adblock is popular with Firefox fans, but no-one wanted to block the ad we're talking about. In fact, it's not even an ad on a page: it's a page ~for~ the ad. The ad itself is indecent enough for us clean folks not to give you the URL, but Carl's Jr., we'll tell you, is a burger chain that invited Ms Hilton of Paris fame to do an ad for them. (Tip: Google "carls jr".)

Now the news here is that with all the oodles of porn on the WWW, hormonal men ~still~ flocked to the Web site to watch Hilton do her act, promoting spicy hamburgers. (We're ~assuming~ it wasn't non-hormonal women.) The servers went down for hours as hot-blooded males (who'd already

Pamela's Poker Plug Pulled

Pamelapoker.com now redirects to doylesroom.com. It was doylesroom.com in the first place; the former Baywatch Babe says she wanted to make "a quick buck" when she took it over. She cites legal red tape and "too many rules in the USA." How sad. No busty cutie any more - a shootfest-hardened cowboy now adorns on the main page.

As a matter of fact, Ms Anderson's diary was brimming over with plans for revealing photos to be featured on the site alongside games of poker. To popularise the game as one of skill and not of chance, no doubt. But, "Too many shady areas. I really don't want to encourage people to gamble. This must be turned off. It just didn't work out. Even in my heart."

Something is amiss there. Yeah, the anti-gambling sentiment smells of saccharine.



And "my heart sounds funny: we hadn't realised this bimbo does have internal organs..."



seen Hilton doing the nasty!) flocked to the site. (Even though Hilton wasn't nude; besides, she ate a hamburger, not a banana.) The site might be up by the time you read this - Google some stuff and try to get at it. We weren't able to.

Sex sells, what?

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